Workplace Health and Safety Manual (Warehouse Operations)

Document ID: EN-MAN-01 **Department:** Health, Safety and Environment (HSE) **Version:** 2.4 **Effective Date:** 1 April 2026 **Applicable Sites:** Distribution Centres 1–4

1. Introduction

This manual sets out the mandatory safety procedures for all personnel working in or visiting Meridian Holdings Group's distribution centres. All employees, contractors, and visitors must complete a site safety induction before entering operational areas.

2. Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

2.1 High-visibility vests must be worn at all times within marked operational zones.

2.2 Steel-toe safety footwear is mandatory for all personnel working on the warehouse floor, including visitors on guided tours.

2.3 Hearing protection must be worn in areas marked with high-noise signage, typically near packing and conveyor machinery.

2.4 Employees operating forklifts or pallet jacks must wear the full PPE set specified in Appendix A, including a hard hat where overhead racking exceeds four metres.

3. Manual Handling

3.1 Employees must not lift loads exceeding 25 kg without mechanical assistance or a second person.

3.2 The correct lifting technique — bending at the knees, keeping the back straight, and holding the load close to the body — must be followed for all manual lifts, as demonstrated during induction training.

3.3 Repetitive lifting tasks are subject to job rotation every two hours to reduce the risk of musculoskeletal injury.

4. Fire Safety

4.1 Fire extinguishers are located at intervals of no more than thirty metres throughout the warehouse floor and are colour-coded by type: red (water), blue (dry powder), and black (CO2).

4.2 In the event of a fire alarm, all personnel must proceed immediately to the designated assembly point shown on the site evacuation map, without collecting personal belongings.

4.3 Fire drills are conducted quarterly. Attendance is mandatory and is recorded by the site HSE Officer.

5. Forklift and Vehicle Operations

5.1 Only personnel holding a valid, in-date forklift operating licence issued by the Company's approved training provider may operate powered industrial trucks.

5.2 A maximum speed of 8 km/h applies to all forklift movement within the warehouse, reduced to walking pace within two metres of pedestrian walkways.

5.3 Pedestrians have right of way at all marked crossing points. Forklift operators must sound the horn when approaching blind corners or intersections.

6. Incident Reporting

6.1 All accidents, near-misses, and equipment defects must be reported to the site HSE Officer within one hour of occurrence using the Incident Report Form (HSE-FORM-02).

6.2 Any injury requiring medical attention beyond basic first aid must be reported to the Head of HSE within twenty-four hours, and a full investigation must be completed within five working days.

7. Emergency Contacts

- Site HSE Officer: extension 2200
- First Aid Room: extension 2210
- Site Security (24-hour): extension 2000

8. Approval

Approved by the Head of Health, Safety and Environment on 20 March 2026, superseding version 2.3 dated 15 September 2024.